

Hypoglycemia - NIDDK

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Low Blood Glucose (Hypoglycemia) - NIDDK Home Health Information Diabetes Diabetes Overview Preventing Diabetes Problems Low Blood Glucose (Hypoglycemia) Related Topics English English Espa#241;ol Low Blood Glucose (Hypoglycemia) On this page: What is low blood glucose? How common is low blood glucose? Who is more likely to develop low blood glucose? What are the symptoms of low blood glucose? What are the complications of low blood glucose? What causes low blood glucose in people with diabetes? How can I prevent low blood glucose if I have diabetes? How do I treat low blood glucose? What if I have severe low blood glucose and can't treat myself? Clinical Trials for Low Blood Glucose What is low blood glucose? Low blood glucose , also called low blood sugar or hypoglycemia, occurs when the level of glucose in your blood drops below what is healthy for you. For many people with diabetes , this means a blood glucose reading lower than 70 milligrams per deciliter (mg/dL). 1 Your number might be different, so check with your doctor or health care team to find out what blood glucose level is low for you. How common is low blood glucose? Low blood glucose is common among people with type 1 diabetes and among people with type 2 diabetes who take insulin or some other diabetes medicines . In a large global study of people with diabetes who take insulin, 4 in 5 people with type 1 diabetes and nearly half of those with type 2 diabetes reported a low blood sugar event at least once over a 4-week period. 2 Severely low blood glucose, defined as when your blood glucose level drops so low you can't treat it yourself, is less c